

Brushes

Traditional watercolor brushes are made from soft hair and those made from sable are considered the best. Sable brushes are expensive, however, so when buying a first set of brushes, look for synthetic and

synthetic/sable blends, which have been developed to mimic pure sable. Whatever a brush is made from, it should point well and hold its shape, be able to hold a generous amount of paint, and be supple and springy.

ROUNDS AND FLATS

Round brushes are conical and can be shaped into a fine point. They are numbered: the larger the brush, the higher its number. Flat brushes are wide and have straight ends. Their size is given by

an imperial or metric measurement. Use the rounds and flats in the recommended brush selection (*see p.13*) to enable you to create a wide range of strokes from fine lines to broad washes, as below.



No. 5 round is perfect for very fine lines and small details.



No. 9 round is suitable for both general use and detail.



No. 14 round is good for general use; it holds more paint than a No. 9.



No. 9 round with squirrel hair is useful for softening edges.



1/2 in (12.5 mm) flat is handy for creating sharp edges and lines.



1 in (25 mm) flat is ideal for making a single stroke across the paper, useful when laying washes.



2 in (50 mm) hake, made from goat's hair, is excellent for broad washes and for covering large areas quickly.